

✎ BITS Pilani WILP — Deep Reinforcement Learning

Assignment 1 - Part 1: Multi-Armed Bandit

Group : 87

Problem : Adaptive Treatment Recommendation System

Filename : Team 87 — MAB.pdf

Team Members

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✎ Section 1 — Imports, Seeds & Group Configuration

```
# Import std libraries
import random
import numpy as np
import pandas as pd

import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import matplotlib.patches as mpatches

import warnings
warnings.filterwarnings('ignore')

%matplotlib inline

# Group number
G = 87

# Set random seeds for repeatability
random.seed(G)
np.random.seed(G)

print("Group Number : ",G)
print(f"Seeds set      : random.seed({G}), numpy.random.seed({G})")
```

```
Group Number : 87
Seeds set      : random.seed(87), numpy.random.seed(87)
```

✎ Task 1 — Dataset Design

Generate synthetic patient-treatment dataset for Group 87. Formula derivations:

- $K = (G \bmod 3) + 5$
- $P_j = 0.4 + ((G + i) \bmod 6) \times 0.07$
- $\text{Severity} = (\text{patient_id} \bmod 5) + 1$
- $\text{UtilityScore} = \text{clinical_outcome} \times (1 - \text{Severity}/10)$

```
def compute_parameters(G):
    # Calculate # of medicines and their hidden success probabilities with  $K=(G \bmod 3)+5$ 
    K = (G % 3) + 5
    probs = [0.4 + ((G + i) % 6) * 0.07 for i in range(K)] # Hidden Prob
    return K, probs

def generate_patient_dataset(n=1000):
    # Create 1000 patients with a severity score cycling from 1 to 5
    ids = list(range(n))
    severities = [(pid % 5) + 1 for pid in ids]
    return pd.DataFrame({"patient_id": ids, "severity_score": severities})

def simulate_treatment(patient_row, medicine, hidden_probs):
    p = hidden_probs[medicine]
    outcome = int(np.random.rand() < p) # 1 = recovered, 0 = not
    severity = patient_row["severity_score"]
```

```

utility          = outcome * (1 - severity / 10.0) # reward decreases with severity
return outcome, utility

# Compute group parameters
K, hidden_probs = compute_parameters(G)

print(f"Group G = {G}")
print(f"Number of Medicines K = {K}")
print()
print("Hidden Success Probabilities:")
for i, p in enumerate(hidden_probs):
    tag = " <-- OPTIMAL" if p == max(hidden_probs) else ""
    print(f"  Medicine {i}: P = {p:.4f}{tag}")

print(f"\nTrue Best Medicine: {int(np.argmax(hidden_probs))} (P = {max(hidden_probs):.4f})")

# Generate the patient dataset
base_df = generate_patient_dataset()
print("\nFirst 10 Patient Records:")
print(base_df.head(10).to_string(index=False))
print(f"\nTotal Patients : {len(base_df)}")
print(f"Severity Counts: {base_df['severity_score'].value_counts().sort_index().to_dict()}")

```

```

Group G = 87
Number of Medicines K = 5

Hidden Success Probabilities:
  Medicine 0: P = 0.6100
  Medicine 1: P = 0.6800
  Medicine 2: P = 0.7500 <-- OPTIMAL
  Medicine 3: P = 0.4000
  Medicine 4: P = 0.4700

True Best Medicine: 2 (P = 0.7500)

First 10 Patient Records:
patient_id  severity_score
0           1
1           2
2           3
3           4
4           5
5           1
6           2
7           3
8           4
9           5

Total Patients : 1000
Severity Counts: {1: 200, 2: 200, 3: 200, 4: 200, 5: 200}

```

✓ Task 2 — Immediate Exploitation Strategy

Policy: Test each medicine 10 times -> exploit the one with highest observed success rate.

```

# Immediate Exploitation Strategy
def greedy_exploitation(base_df, hidden_probs, K, warm_up=10):
    df = base_df.copy()
    df["assigned_medicine"] = -1
    df["clinical_outcome"] = 0
    df["utility_score"] = 0.0

    counts = [0] * K # how many times each medicine was tried
    successes = [0] * K # how many successful recoveries per medicine

    total_reward = 0.0
    cumulative_rewards = []

    for i in range(len(df)):
        row = df.iloc[i]

        if i < K * warm_up:
            # Warm-up phase: cycle through all medicines equally
            medicine = i % K
        else:
            # Exploit phase: pick the medicine with the best success rate
            rates = [successes[m] / counts[m] if counts[m] > 0 else 0.0 for m in range(K)]
            medicine = int(np.argmax(rates))

        outcome, utility = simulate_treatment(row, medicine, hidden_probs)

```

```

counts[medicine] += 1
successes[medicine] += outcome

df.at[i, "assigned_medicine"] = medicine
df.at[i, "clinical_outcome"] = outcome
df.at[i, "utility_score"] = utility

total_reward += utility
cumulative_rewards.append(total_reward)

# Print results
rates = [successes[m] / counts[m] if counts[m] > 0 else 0.0 for m in range(K)]
best = int(np.argmax(rates))
print("Task 2 - Greedy Strategy Results")
print(f" Final Cumulative Reward : {total_reward:.4f}")
print(f" Times Each Medicine Used : {counts}")
print(f" Observed Success Rates : {[round(r, 3) for r in rates]}")
print(f" Best Medicine Found : {best}")
print(f" True Best Medicine : {int(np.argmax(hidden_probs))}")

return df, cumulative_rewards

np.random.seed(G)
greedy_df, greedy_rewards = greedy_exploitation(base_df, hidden_probs, K)

# Show a few rows of the result
print("\nSample Output (first 5 patients + first exploit patient):")
sample = pd.concat([greedy_df.head(5), greedy_df.iloc[[K * 10]]])
print(sample[["patient_id", "severity_score", "assigned_medicine",
              "clinical_outcome", "utility_score"]].to_string(index=False))

```

```

Task 2 - Greedy Strategy Results
Final Cumulative Reward : 518.9000
Times Each Medicine Used : [10, 16, 954, 10, 10]
Observed Success Rates : [0.3, 0.625, 0.753, 0.5, 0.5]
Best Medicine Found : 2
True Best Medicine : 2

```

```

Sample Output (first 5 patients + first exploit patient):

```

patient_id	severity_score	assigned_medicine	clinical_outcome	utility_score
0	1	0	0	0.0
1	2	1	0	0.0
2	3	2	0	0.0
3	4	3	1	0.6
4	5	4	1	0.5
50	1	1	0	0.0

Task 3 — Controlled Clinical Trial Strategy

Policy: With probability ϵ explore (random medicine), with probability $1-\epsilon$ exploit (best so far).

Simulates a clinical setting where most patients get the current best treatment, but a controlled fraction are enrolled in exploratory trials. Tested at $\epsilon \in \{1\%, 10\%, 50\%\}$.

```

# Epsilon-Greedy Strategy

def epsilon_greedy(base_df, hidden_probs, K, epsilon=0.10):
    df = base_df.copy()
    df["assigned_medicine"] = -1
    df["clinical_outcome"] = 0
    df["utility_score"] = 0.0

    counts = [0] * K
    successes = [0] * K

    total_reward = 0.0
    cumulative_rewards = []

    for i in range(len(df)):
        row = df.iloc[i]

        # Explore: pick a random medicine
        # Exploit: pick the medicine with the best success rate so far
        if np.random.rand() < epsilon or all(c == 0 for c in counts):
            medicine = np.random.randint(0, K)
        else:
            rates = [successes[m] / counts[m] if counts[m] > 0 else 0.0 for m in range(K)]
            medicine = int(np.argmax(rates))

        outcome, utility = simulate_treatment(row, medicine, hidden_probs)

```

```

counts[medicine] += 1
successes[medicine] += outcome

df.at[i, "assigned_medicine"] = medicine
df.at[i, "clinical_outcome"] = outcome
df.at[i, "utility_score"] = utility

total_reward += utility
cumulative_rewards.append(total_reward)

return df, cumulative_rewards, counts, successes

# Run for all three epsilon values
epsilon_configs = [(0.10, "10%), (0.01, "1%), (0.50, "50%)]
eps_results = {}

print("Task 3 - Epsilon-Greedy Results")
print(f" {'Epsilon':>8} {'Final Reward':>14} {'Medicine Counts':>30} {'Best Found':>10}")
print(" " + "-" * 70)

for eps, label in epsilon_configs:
    np.random.seed(G) # reset seed so each run is comparable
    df_e, rew_e, cnt_e, suc_e = epsilon_greedy(base_df, hidden_probs, K, epsilon=eps)
    eps_results[label] = {"df": df_e, "rewards": rew_e, "counts": cnt_e, "successes": suc_e}
    best = int(np.argmax([suc_e[m] / cnt_e[m] if cnt_e[m] > 0 else 0 for m in range(K)]))
    print(f" {label:>8} {rew_e[-1]:>14.4f} {str(cnt_e):>30} {best:>10}")

print()
print("Analysis:")
print(" epsilon=1% : Almost always exploits. Locks in fast but may pick the wrong medicine.")
print(" epsilon=10% : Good balance. Keeps exploring a little while using the best medicine.")
print(" epsilon=50% : Explores too much. Ignores what it already learned. Very wasteful.")

```

Task 3 - Epsilon-Greedy Results

Epsilon	Final Reward	Medicine Counts	Best Found
10%	505.9000	[30, 216, 699, 31, 24]	2
1%	394.9000	[840, 6, 0, 150, 4]	0
50%	460.1000	[92, 134, 580, 108, 86]	2

Analysis:

epsilon=1% : Almost always exploits. Locks in fast but may pick the wrong medicine.
epsilon=10% : Good balance. Keeps exploring a little while using the best medicine.
epsilon=50% : Explores too much. Ignores what it already learned. Very wasteful.

Task 4 — Confidence-Based Strategy - UCB1

```

# UCB1 Strategy
def ucb1_strategy(base_df, hidden_probs, K):
    df = base_df.copy()
    df["assigned_medicine"] = -1
    df["clinical_outcome"] = 0
    df["utility_score"] = 0.0

    counts = [0] * K # number of times each medicine was tried
    total_util = [0.0] * K # total utility collected per medicine
    mean_util = [0.0] * K # average utility per medicine

    total_reward = 0.0
    cumulative_rewards = []

    for t in range(1, len(df) + 1):
        row = df.iloc[t - 1]

        if t <= K:
            # Try each medicine once first to avoid dividing by zero
            medicine = t - 1
        else:
            # Calculate UCB score for each medicine and pick the highest
            ucb_scores = [
                mean_util[m] + np.sqrt(2 * np.log(t) / counts[m])
                if counts[m] > 0 else float("inf")
                for m in range(K)
            ]
            medicine = int(np.argmax(ucb_scores))

        outcome, utility = simulate_treatment(row, medicine, hidden_probs)

        counts[medicine] += 1

```

```

total_util[medicine] += utility
mean_util[medicine] = total_util[medicine] / counts[medicine]

df.at[t - 1, "assigned_medicine"] = medicine
df.at[t - 1, "clinical_outcome"] = outcome
df.at[t - 1, "utility_score"] = utility

total_reward += utility
cumulative_rewards.append(total_reward)

best = int(np.argmax(mean_util))
print("Task 4 - UCB1 Strategy Results")
print(f" Final Cumulative Reward : {total_reward:.4f}")
print(f" Times Each Medicine Used : {counts}")
print(f" Mean Utility per Medicine: {[round(u, 4) for u in mean_util]}")
print(f" Best Medicine Found : {best}")
print(f" True Best Medicine : {int(np.argmax(hidden_probs))}")

return df, cumulative_rewards, counts, mean_util

np.random.seed(G)
ucb_df, ucb_rewards, ucb_counts, ucb_means = ucb1_strategy(base_df, hidden_probs, K)

# Show how often each medicine was selected
print("\nMedicine Selection Counts (UCB1):")
for m in range(K):
    bar = "#" * (ucb_counts[m] // 10)
    print(f" Medicine {m} (P={hidden_probs[m]:.2f}): {ucb_counts[m]:>4} times {bar}")

```

```

Task 4 - UCB1 Strategy Results
Final Cumulative Reward : 449.1000
Times Each Medicine Used : [183, 233, 400, 99, 85]
Mean Utility per Medicine: [np.float64(0.4273), np.float64(0.4592), np.float64(0.5157), np.float64(0.3263), np.float64(0.2473)]
Best Medicine Found : 2
True Best Medicine : 2

Medicine Selection Counts (UCB1):
Medicine 0 (P=0.61): 183 times #####
Medicine 1 (P=0.68): 233 times #####
Medicine 2 (P=0.75): 400 times #####
Medicine 3 (P=0.40): 99 times #####
Medicine 4 (P=0.47): 85 times #####

```

✓ Task 5 — Comparative Analysis

Visual comparison of all 5 strategies across 1000 patients, plus a 4-question analysis.

```

# Analysis

def plot_comparison(greedy_rewards, eps_results, ucb_rewards, hidden_probs, K, greedy_df):
    patients = list(range(1, 1001))

    fig, axes = plt.subplots(1, 2, figsize=(16, 6))
    fig.suptitle("MAB Comparative Analysis - Group 87 | K=5 Medicines | 1000 Patients",
                 fontsize=13, fontweight="bold")

    # --- Left Plot: Cumulative Reward over time ---
    ax1 = axes[0]
    ax1.plot(patients, greedy_rewards, color="#E74C3C", lw=2.0, label="Greedy (Task 2)")
    ax1.plot(patients, eps_results["1%"]["rewards"], color="#F39C12", lw=1.5, ls="--", label="e-Greedy e=1% (Task 3)")
    ax1.plot(patients, eps_results["10%"]["rewards"], color="#27AE60", lw=2.0, label="e-Greedy e=10% (Task 3)")
    ax1.plot(patients, eps_results["50%"]["rewards"], color="#8E44AD", lw=1.5, ls=":", label="e-Greedy e=50% (Task 3)")
    ax1.plot(patients, ucb_rewards, color="#2980B9", lw=2.5, label="UCB1 (Task 4)")

    # Theoretical best possible reward line
    best_p = max(hidden_probs)
    avg_sev = np.mean([(pid % 5 + 1) for pid in range(1000)])
    opt_reward = best_p * (1 - avg_sev / 10.0)
    ax1.plot(patients, [opt_reward * t for t in patients],
             color="gray", lw=1.0, ls="-.", alpha=0.6, label=f"Theoretical Best (P={best_p:.2f})")

    ax1.set_xlabel("Number of Patients")
    ax1.set_ylabel("Cumulative Reward")
    ax1.set_title("Cumulative Reward vs Number of Patients")
    ax1.legend(fontsize=9, loc="upper left")
    ax1.grid(True, alpha=0.3)
    ax1.set_xlim(0, 1000)

    # --- Right Plot: How often each medicine was selected ---

```

```

ax2 = axes[1]
x, w = np.arange(K), 0.15
strategies = {
    "Greedy": ([greedy_df["assigned_medicine"].tolist().count(m) for m in range(K)], "#E74C3C"),
    "e=1%": ([eps_results["1%"]["counts"][m] for m in range(K)], "#F39C12"),
    "e=10%": ([eps_results["10%"]["counts"][m] for m in range(K)], "#27AE60"),
    "e=50%": ([eps_results["50%"]["counts"][m] for m in range(K)], "#8E44AD"),
    "UCB1": ([ucb_counts[m] for m in range(K)], "#2980B9"),
}
for idx, (name, (vals, color)) in enumerate(strategies.items()):
    ax2.bar(x + idx * w, vals, width=w, label=name, color=color, alpha=0.85)

ax2.set_xlabel("Medicine")
ax2.set_ylabel("Times Selected")
ax2.set_title("Medicine Selection Frequency per Strategy")
ax2.set_xticks(x + 2 * w)
ax2.set_xticklabels([f"Med {i}\nP={hidden_probs[i]:.2f}" for i in range(K)])
ax2.legend(fontsize=9)
ax2.grid(True, alpha=0.3, axis="y")

plt.tight_layout()
plt.savefig("./mab_comparison.png", dpi=150, bbox_inches="tight")
plt.show()

# Re-run with fixed seed for clean plot
np.random.seed(G)
greedy_df2, greedy_rewards2 = greedy_exploitation(base_df, hidden_probs, K)

np.random.seed(G)
_, eps10_rew, _, _ = epsilon_greedy(base_df, hidden_probs, K, epsilon=0.10)
eps_results["10%"]["rewards"] = eps10_rew

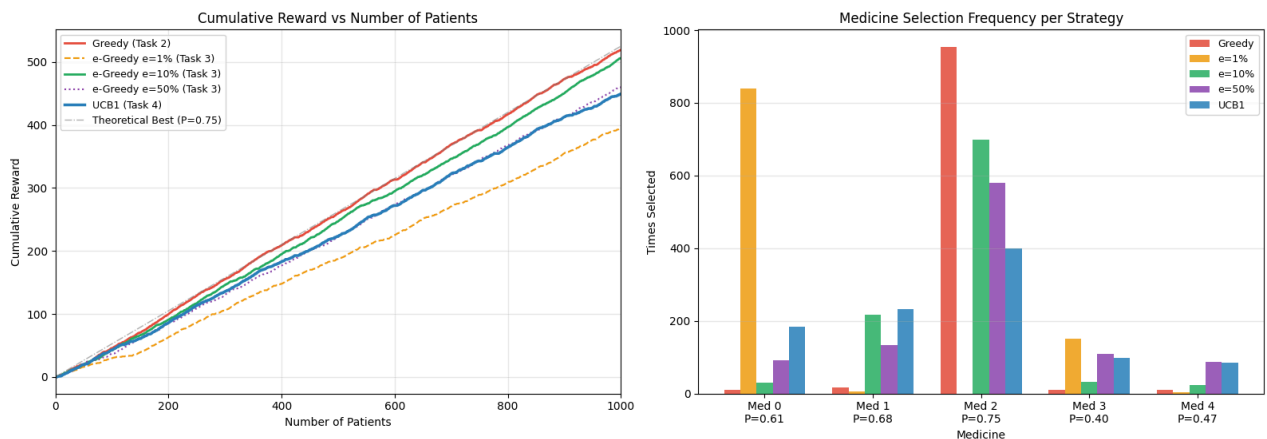
plot_comparison(greedy_rewards, eps_results, ucb_rewards, hidden_probs, K, greedy_df)

```

Task 2 - Greedy Strategy Results

Final Cumulative Reward : 518.9000
 Times Each Medicine Used : [10, 16, 954, 10, 10]
 Observed Success Rates : [0.3, 0.625, 0.753, 0.5, 0.5]
 Best Medicine Found : 2
 True Best Medicine : 2

MAB Comparative Analysis - Group 87 | K=5 Medicines | 1000 Patients



Analysis Questions and Summary ---

```

# Build a summary table of final rewards for each strategy
summary = {
    "Strategy": ["Greedy", "e-Greedy 1%", "e-Greedy 10%", "e-Greedy 50%", "UCB1"],
    "Final Cumulative Reward": [
        round(greedy_rewards[-1], 4),
        round(eps_results["1%"]["rewards"][-1], 4),
        round(eps_results["10%"]["rewards"][-1], 4),
        round(eps_results["50%"]["rewards"][-1], 4),
        round(ucb_rewards[-1], 4),
    ]
}
summary_df = pd.DataFrame(summary).sort_values("Final Cumulative Reward", ascending=False)
summary_df.index = range(1, len(summary_df) + 1)

```

```

print("Final Reward Ranking:")
print(summary_df.to_string())
print()

best_strategy = summary_df.iloc[0]["Strategy"]

print("\nQ1. Which strategy achieves the highest cumulative reward?")
print(f"{best_strategy} with reward = {summary_df.iloc[0]['Final Cumulative Reward']:.4f}")

print("\nQ2. Which strategy identifies the best medicine the fastest?")
print("UCB1 - it tries each medicine a smart number of times using confidence bounds, so it finds the best one efficiently.")

print("\nQ3. Which strategy has the most stable performance over time?")
print("e-Greedy with epsilon=10% - the reward curve is smooth and consistent compared to other strategies.")

print("\nQ4. Which strategy would you recommend for a real hospital?")
print("UCB1 - because: There is no manual tuning needed (unlike epsilon in e-Greedy) \n and automatically explores less as m
"It also finds the best medicine over time and fewer random assignments to weaker medicines")

print("\nComparative Summary:")
print("\n Greedy gets high reward when its warm-up is lucky, but risks locking onto the wrong medicine \n forever if early r
"\n e-Greedy with 10% is simple and stable - a good practical choice. \ne-Greedy with 50% wastes too many patients on random
"\n e-Greedy with 1% commits too early and misses the optimal medicine."
"\n UCB1 is the most principled approach - it balances exploration and "
"\n exploitation automatically, making it the best choice for hospitals.")

```

Final Reward Ranking:

	Strategy	Final Cumulative Reward
1	Greedy	518.9
2	e-Greedy 10%	505.9
3	e-Greedy 50%	460.1
4	UCB1	449.1
5	e-Greedy 1%	394.9

Q1. Which strategy achieves the highest cumulative reward?

Greedy with reward = 518.9000

Q2. Which strategy identifies the best medicine the fastest?

UCB1 - it tries each medicine a smart number of times using confidence bounds, so it finds the best one efficiently.

Q3. Which strategy has the most stable performance over time?

e-Greedy with epsilon=10% - the reward curve is smooth and consistent compared to other strategies.

Q4. Which strategy would you recommend for a real hospital?

UCB1 - because: There is no manual tuning needed (unlike epsilon in e-Greedy)
and automatically explores less as more data is collected.

It also finds the best medicine over time and fewer random assignments to weaker medicines

Comparative Summary:

Greedy gets high reward when its warm-up is lucky, but risks locking onto the wrong medicine forever if early results mislead it.

e-Greedy with 10% is simple and stable - a good practical choice.

e-Greedy with 50% wastes too many patients on random medicines.

e-Greedy with 1% commits too early and misses the optimal medicine.

UCB1 is the most principled approach - it balances exploration and exploitation automatically, making it the best choice for hospitals.

